

1947, February 27

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by
the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.
(A carbon copy mailed to Mr. & Mrs. J. J. O'Donnell)

COPY

February 27th 1947.

Mr. M.C. Costello.
Hargill, Texas.

St. Felix Friary
Huntington, Ind.

My Dear Mr. Costello: God bless you and yours. The O'Donnells told me several weeks ago that you were writing me -- having told me quite allittle about you for several past months. Only just now did I come across your interesting letter of February 26th -- somehow mislaid -- that I've been looking for. So I am not keeping you in any possible suspence as to my identity, interest, etc.

You ask about Appleton, Wisconsin. It was in St. Joseph's Church in that neat little city where I had my first Holy Mass, July 31st 1904. God be blessed. Deo Gr. No. I can not say that I am exactly from St. Paul, Minn; though many a pleasant day I spent in that thrifty city - with relatives and friends and in the Seminary, as guest.

Coming two years in June, on my way to Seattle, I visited an old friend of mine Mike Costello who had been moldest brother's bare-foot-boy friend on our farms sixty-five years before and about forty miles down the River on the Wisconsin side. Later, when I was about 17, I did a term in the Stillwater Penetentiary (less than two months), and I found Mike there ahead of me and we became bed-fellows - he a boiler-maker and his partner just "a roustabout". However, we had our sleeping-quarters outside the wall.

Some years after ~~that~~ the one became a lieutenant in the Saint Paul police-department; the other a poor Capuchin and a priest. Mike was in his 80s and was almost blind when we went to see him on said trip - seemingly rejuvenated at our visit. I had spoken to him on the phone a number of times but for over thirty years had not seen him. So that, when our O'Donnell Friends seemed disappointed several weeks back I felt there must be a mistake or a misunderstanding "in the woodpile" somewhere. Thanks be to God for all interested it turned out to be so, - just another blessing in disguise I trust. For I feel that as you learn to know these friends, as I have known them for several years, you will come to feel that you are rather working with them than just for them. Indeed I hope such feeling of confidence may become generously mutual between you.
..... God bless you all again.

Sincerely Yours in Christ, Fr. Solanus, O.F.M. Cap.

Best regards to the Conley group.
Pl pardon brevity.

Praised be Jesus Christ.
Fr. Solanus